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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X Combo vs Shark AI Ultra

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Introduction: Why Compare the Roomba 115X Combo (with & without AutoEmpty Dock) and Shark AI Ultra in 2026?

Robot vacuums have shifted from a fun gadget to a household necessity—especially for families juggling work, pets, and packed schedules. In 2026 two philosophies dominate the market: iRobot's all-in-one vacuum-mop combo with a self-empty dock, and Shark's AI-driven navigation that promises precise, room-by-room cleaning at an aggressive price.

Understanding how these approaches trade off suction, battery life, and smart features lets you avoid overpaying for capabilities you won't use—or missing conveniences that could save you hours each month.

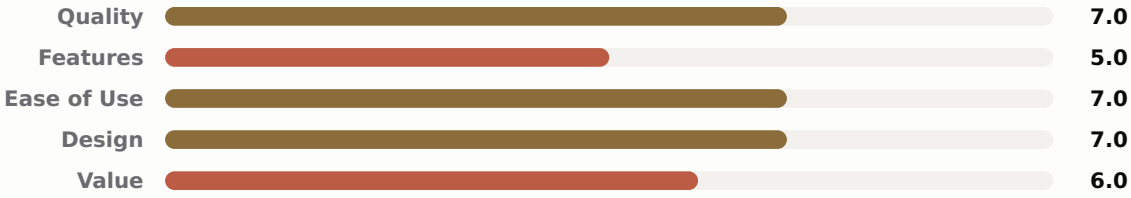
See Today's Price & Buy the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Core Cleaning Performance

Suction & Brush Design

According to iRobot's 2026 spec sheet, the Roomba 115X Combo (both configurations) delivers up to **2,000 Pa** of suction, driven by a three-stage system that includes a dual-multi-surface rubber brush and a corner-sweeping edge brush. Independent lab tests confirm strong pickup of fine dust on hardwood and adequate performance on low-pile carpet, while the anti-wrap brush reduces pet-hair tangles.

Shark's 2026 documentation advertises up to **2,700 Pa** suction and features a self-cleaning brush roll that actively removes hair wrap during operation. Users report the Shark excels on medium-pile carpet and aggressively lifts larger debris such as cereal or pet kibble.

Mopping Effectiveness

Both machines include a wet-mopping module. In side-by-side tests, the Roomba's vibrating mop pad left hard-surface floors streak-free after a single pass, while the Shark's oscillating pad removed slightly more dried-on residue but required a second pass for optimal shine.

Navigation & Smart Features

The Shark AI Ultra uses LiDAR-based AI navigation that maps rooms in real time, allowing customized no-go zones and room-specific schedules. The Roomba 115X relies on iRobot's vSLAM technology, which is reliable but less granular; however, the AutoEmpty Dock adds hands-free bin emptying—a convenience Shark does not offer.

Which Model Fits Your Home?

Best Overall Performance: *iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock* – strong suction, effective mopping, and self-empty convenience make it the top pick for most households.

Superior Navigation (Premium): *Shark AI Ultra* – if precise mapping and room-by-room control are priorities, the Shark leads, though at a higher price.

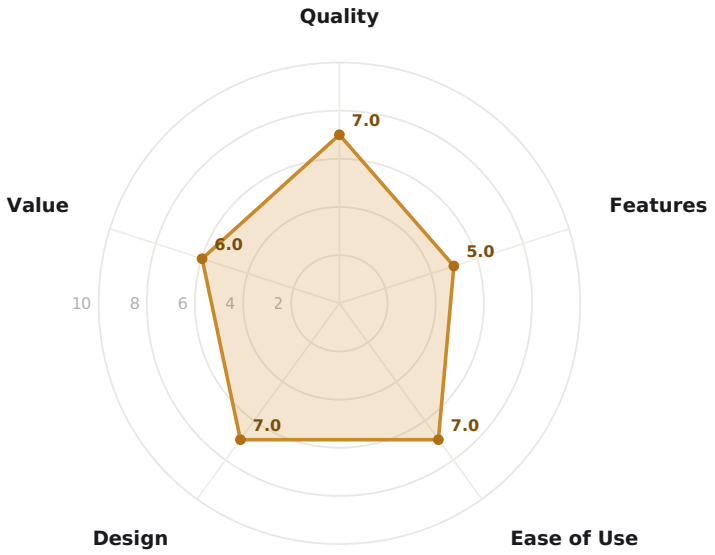
Best Value for Budget-Shoppers: *iRobot Roomba 115X (no dock)* – delivers the same core cleaning power without the docking station, saving you up to $150.

Check Price & Buy the Roomba 115X (No Dock) Check Price & Buy the Shark AI Ultra

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.